

Reconnection and Recalibration

The Post-COVID Reorganization of U.S.-Japan Air Travel, 2019-2025

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Abstract

Using Bureau of Transportation Statistics (BTS) T-100 International Segment data spanning a seven-year period from 2019-2025, this analysis documents the post-COVID recovery and structural reorganization of the U.S.-Japan corridor in commercial aviation. By 2025, the corridor recovered 91% of its 2019 passenger levels, but this surface-level finding hides a restructuring of the fundamentals of the corridor. The March 2020 Haneda (HND) slot expansion redirected traffic away from Narita (NRT), creating new nonstop location pairs that had not meaningfully existed before COVID. U.S.-originating demand recovered fully, and exceeded 2019 levels at most mainland gateways, with United and ANA's Star Alliance expanding its market share from 41.6% to 47.2%. Japanese-originating leisure demand, being suppressed by a historically weak yen, remains significantly below 2019 levels – most visibly in Honolulu and Guam, the latter of which remains at 62% of 2019 volume. The corridor's monthly coefficient of variation increased from 7.1% to 9.8% since 2019, reflecting a higher amount of seasonal demand concentration consistent with a shift toward American-origin leisure demand, which is heavily concentrated in the spring and autumn travel seasons. The corridor hasn't only recovered from COVID; it also recalibrated around a different airport, and new routes, paving the way for the emergence of a new LCC entity with a different traveler demographic.

Introduction

The U.S.-Japan corridor is a highly studied transpacific market, in large part due to dominant flag-carrier competition and deep cultural and economic ties between two of the world's largest economies. Despite these close ties, Japan would maintain some of the strictest and drawn-out travel restrictions of any major nation, with the corridor connecting the two countries remaining as low as 7% of its 2019 volume as late as 2021.

By 2025, the corridor has mostly “recovered” to 91% of its 2019 volume – a figure that suggests a stabilization; one might expect this number to hover around 100% in 2026. This analysis writes a more nuanced story of the corridor's recovery: it hadn't simply returned to its normal operations but rather underwent a complete realignment in the background.

Four different structural shifts define the post-COVID corridor. Firstly, the 2020 expansion of Haneda Airport's international slot allocation – timed at the onset of COVID, created a fresh competitive landscape when travel reopened and the expansion operated at scale in 2023. The result was a drastic shift of traffic out of Narita. Second, American demand for travel in Japan exploded, driven in part by a yen reaching 30-year lows in terms of strength, and the rise of short-form social media content showcasing Japan's culture and natural beauty. Third, Japanese outbound leisure travel, particularly to Hawaii and Guam, remain deflated due to the same weak yen that incentivizes American travel. Lastly, the seasonal profile of the corridor has shown an increase in volatility since 2019, with the coefficient of variation rising from 7.1% to 9.8%. While the trough month shifted from February to July in 2025, this more so appears to reflect supply decisions rather than demand signals, considering that load factors remained steady at 82.2%.

Personal Anecdote

For my fall 2025 semester, I made a life-changing decision to study abroad in Nagasaki and found the number of ways to reach Japan from home truly fascinating. Several options were on the table: a Star Alliance itinerary connecting at a United hub, a Oneworld selection connecting in DFW or O'Hare, a purely-Delta itinerary connecting in the north, and even a lone nonstop flight directly from Boston to Narita operated by JAL. Ultimately, I chose to fly with Star Alliance, connecting at Dulles to board a 14-hour flight to Haneda operated by ANA on a Boeing 787 Dreamliner.

As a college student, cost was a large factor in that decision, with a \$1,300 roundtrip fare making up for what ultimately could be considered an inefficient route – traveling south instead of north for a connecting flight that usually flies over Alaska.

Data and Methodology

BTS T-100 International Segment data reports monthly totals by route, aircraft, and carrier for all international trips with a U.S. destination as either the origin or endpoint. Each record contains passengers, seats, and departures performed, allowing for direct calculation of load factors on these operated flights.

A seven-year period is built by stacking annual files from 2019-2025. Japan-specific records are isolated using its unique World Area Code (WAC), which covers all Japan-located airports. U.S. territories such as Guam and Honolulu are treated as international endpoints, given their relevance to Japanese leisure routes.

All recovery calculations are conditioned against 2019 as the pre-COVID baseline. Year-over-year (YoY) comparisons are avoided for 2020-2022 due to distortion resulting from COVID. Carrier and alliance groupings are assigned based on carrier codes.

Corridor-Level Recovery

The U.S.-Japan corridor carried 10.8 million passengers in 2019, making it a dominating force in the transpacific market. The COVID collapse brought upon a severe and prolonged period of inactivity: 2021 saw merely 806,000 passengers, a reduction of 93%, as Japan maintained strict entry restrictions well after most other international markets had reopened.

Year	Passengers	Seats	Flights	Load Factor	Pax Index (2019=1.00)	Seat Index
2019	10,808,980	13,184,135	62,155	82.0%	1.00	1.00
2020	2,342,878	4,605,556	35,181	50.9%	0.22	0.35
2021	806,293	3,284,379	36,492	24.5%	0.07	0.25
2022	3,578,798	5,776,575	42,406	62.0%	0.33	0.44
2023	8,242,469	10,681,736	55,624	77.2%	0.76	0.81
2024	9,514,131	12,347,923	61,520	77.1%	0.88	0.94
2025	9,881,607	11,900,712	58,841	83.0%	0.91	0.90

Table 1 - U.S.-Japan corridor annual statistics, 2019–2025. Source: BTS T-100.

Two distinct phases are revealed in the recovery trajectory. The initial rebound in 2023 was strong: up to 76% of 2019 levels after Japan’s full reopening in October 2022. The second phase from 2023 shows a continuous upward trend, although flattened. In the two-year span, passenger numbers rebounded to 91% of 2019 numbers, implying that the “easy” recovery had already occurred, and the remaining 9% gap is more of a structural problem.

Note the 2025 load factor of 83%, which exceeds the 2019 level by a single percentage point. Seat capacity is at 90% of 2019 levels while passengers are at 91% - implying that airlines reduced capacity (supply), slightly more than demand, tightening load factors as a result. This recovery is supply-managed, and not a degrading of demand. The corridor operates efficiently, even if at a slightly smaller scale.

Shifting Seasonal Profile

A notable shift in the corridor’s seasonal trends has occurred since 2019. The monthly coefficient of variation increased from 7.1% to 9.8%, signaling that demand is being concentrated in higher amounts towards specific windows, largely consistent with growing American-originating travelers who desire cherry blossom season in the spring, and foliage season during autumn.

The monthly trough shifted from February in 2019 to July in 2025. However, load factor data implies that this is a supply-driven shift rather than demand-driven: July 2025 recorded 830,959 seats and 4,214 flights – the second lowest values of any month in 2025, while still maintaining a load factor of 82.2%, a healthy value. Rather than a pure supply decision, this represents the work of network planners successfully anticipating a sharp demand dip and slashing capacity in advance to protect the profitability of the route.

Metric	2019	2025	Change	Interpretation
Monthly CV (seasonality)	7.1%	9.8%	+2.7pp	More seasonal variation
Peak month	August	August	Unchanged	Summer peak holds
Trough month	February	July	Shifted	Supply scheduling reduction
Mean monthly passengers	900,748	823,467	-8.6%	Volume still below 2019

Table 2 - Seasonality metrics: 2019 vs. 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

The explanation for this July trough lies in fleet allocation and overall supply, rather than traveler behavior. Summer is the peak season for transatlantic travel to Europe. Because airlines operate a limited amount of widebody fleets, network planners often reallocate aircraft away from the U.S.–Japan corridor to capture premium yields across the Atlantic. The healthy load factor (82.2%) proves that passenger demand for Japan remained resilient in July, but airlines are “capping” the corridor's volume by restricting seat supply to chase higher margins elsewhere.

The increased coefficient of variation (+2.7pp) reflects a corridor with more volatile peaks and troughs – a characteristic commonly associated with leisure-dominant demand profiles, where American tourism to Japan is concentrated heavily in two primary seasons.

The Haneda Shift

The most significant structural change in the corridor is invisible at the aggregate passenger count level: it is in which Tokyo airport these passengers choose to operate through. In 2019, Haneda (HND) handled a mere 21% of Tokyo traffic, with Narita (NRT) handling 79%. By 2025, Haneda had usurped the majority between the two airports: 58%, with Narita handling 42%.

Year	HND Passengers	NRT Passengers	HND Share	HND LF	NRT LF	HND Carriers	NRT Carriers
2019	1,889,089	7,055,563	21.1%	82.7%	82.2%	12	27
2020	461,090	1,546,453	23.0%	41.8%	51.5%	14	26
2021	302,245	476,552	38.8%	21.6%	26.3%	9	23
2022	1,339,375	2,136,255	38.5%	62.5%	63.2%	13	24
2023	4,273,881	3,378,757	55.8%	79.7%	76.9%	16	24
2024	5,056,817	3,665,829	58.0%	80.6%	76.0%	11	25
2025	5,295,153	3,764,134	58.4%	84.8%	81.8%	13	29

Table 3 - HND vs. NRT annual passenger comparison, 2019–2025. Source: BTS T-100.

This seemingly sudden shift towards Haneda can be explained by the 2020 Haneda slot expansion. When the corridor reopened at scale in late 2022, airlines activated these slots in tandem, more than doubling Haneda’s passengers in a single year. Haneda was now serving 37 U.S. cities.

Haneda’s load factor advantage over Narita (+3.0pp) validates the shift. Haneda attracts higher-yield business travelers due to its closer proximity to central Tokyo. This is further corroborated

by configuration data: Boeing 777-300ER average seats per departure at Haneda declined by 13.4% from 2019-2025 (245 -> 212). This suggests that airlines may be deploying higher-proportion premium configurations in their cabins. The same aircraft type also became less densified at Narita (272 to 238 seats).

Gateway	City	2019 Pax	2025 Pax	Index (2019=1)	2025 LF
New Regular Haneda Routes					
SEA–HND	Seattle	481	323,464	672x	84.3%
DFW–HND	Dallas	230	286,217	1,244x	88.8%
IAD–HND	Washington	4	270,984	67,746x	80.5%
DTW–HND	Detroit	513	182,127	355x	83.7%
ATL–HND	Atlanta	533	178,913	336x	86.4%
Established Routes (grown)					
LAX–HND	Los Angeles	524,171	1,094,583	2.09x	87.9%
JFK–HND	New York	259,792	668,906	2.57x	83.8%
ORD–HND	Chicago	135,911	445,260	3.28x	83.5%
NRT Routes in Decline					
HNL–NRT	Honolulu	1,643,631	708,773	-57%	78.1%
ORD–NRT	Chicago	509,956	127,860	-75%	82.6%
DFW–NRT	Dallas	449,658	162,354	-64%	84.5%

Table 4 - Selected U.S.–Japan routes: 2019 vs. 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

The cities that gained Haneda slots; Seattle, Dallas, Washington, Detroit, and Atlanta, had essentially zero direct Tokyo service in 2019, with the Haneda expansion creating an entirely

new layer of connectivity between the two countries. While this was occurring, legacy Narita routes were either abandoned or drastically reduced in capacity as carriers continued to shift towards Haneda.

Because Haneda operates 24/7, these slots add massive scheduling flexibility on top of the geographically convenient positioning of the airport itself. For transpacific flights that require complex connections, being free from Narita's midnight-6AM curfew grants a sizable advantage.

Demand vs. Supply: The Load Factor Test

At the corridor level, load factors improved by one percentage point from 2019-2025 (82.0 -> 83.0), with seat capacity remaining at 90% of 2019 levels. Airlines did not oversupply the corridor during the recovery phase, keeping load factors at healthy levels. The gateway-level reveals a more nuanced picture.

Gateway	2019 Pax	2025 Pax	Pax Index	Seat Index	2019 LF	2025 LF	LF Change
Exceeded 2019							
LAX	1,547,353	1,918,199	1.24x	1.17x	82.1%	86.7%	+4.5pp
SFO	768,099	1,164,509	1.52x	1.46x	79.5%	82.8%	+3.2pp
JFK	521,801	672,652	1.29x	1.21x	78.6%	83.8%	+5.1pp
EWR	209,212	319,651	1.53x	1.51x	82.5%	83.7%	+1.2pp
SEA	438,465	528,490	1.21x	1.18x	82.1%	83.8%	+1.7pp
Structurally Suppressed							
HNL	3,224,657	1,995,822	0.62x	0.64x	85.5%	82.1%	-3.3pp
GUM	1,011,789	624,186	0.62x	0.66x	80.9%	75.5%	-5.4pp
Partial Recovery							
ORD	645,867	573,339	0.89x	0.84x	78.8%	83.3%	+4.5pp

DFW	449,888	448,575	1.00x	0.96x	84.1%	87.2%	+3.1pp
IAH	316,462	358,835	1.13x	1.14x	81.9%	81.1%	-0.8pp

Table 5 - U.S. gateway recovery: passengers, seats, and load factor, 2019 vs. 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

Every mainland U.S. gateway – whether located in the West, Midwest, or East, showed improving load factors compared to 2019, consistent with higher American-originating demand filling capacity efficiently. Honolulu and Guam; two destinations that are dominated by Japanese leisure travel, have suffered declines. HNL fell 3.3 percentage points and GUM dropped by 5.4 percentage points, even with both lowering capacity to roughly two-thirds of 2019 levels.

This geographic deviation shows clear evidence of the asymmetry of demand: American travelers are filling seats effectively on routes they frequent. Japanese travelers are not, in some way due to the severe weakening of the yen.

Carrier Asymmetry and Alliance Dynamics

Separating carriers by their country reveals diverging recovery trajectories between U.S. and Japanese carriers. An alliance-level view shows the beneficiaries of the corridor's restructuring.

Carrier	Code	2019 Pax	2025 Pax	Change	Index
U.S. Carriers					
United	UA	2,380,826	2,459,102	+78,276	1.03x
American	AA	730,953	809,792	+78,839	1.11x
Delta	DL	1,616,430	1,035,931	-580,499	0.64x
Hawaiian	HA	844,937	702,373	-142,564	0.83x
Japanese Carriers					
ANA	NH	2,113,474	2,204,024	+90,550	1.04x
JAL	JL	2,388,715	1,976,818	-411,897	0.83x
New Entrant					
ZIPAIR	ZG	0	530,444	+530,444	New

Table 6 - U.S.–Japan passenger change by carrier, 2019 vs. 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

Alliance / Group	2019 Pax	2019 Share	2025 Pax	2025 Share
Star Alliance (United / ANA)	4,494,300	41.6%	4,663,126	47.2%
Oneworld (American / JAL)	3,119,668	28.9%	2,786,610	28.2%
SkyTeam (Delta solo)	1,616,430	15.0%	1,035,931	10.5%
Independent (Hawaiian, etc.)	1,578,582	14.6%	865,496	8.8%
LCC (ZIPAIR)	0	0.0%	530,444	5.4%

Table 7 - Alliance market share, U.S.–Japan corridor, 2019 vs. 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

The alliance view shows a clear summary of who “won” the corridor restructuring phase. Star Alliance gained 5.6 percentage points – driven by United’s aggressive expansion at Haneda and ANA’s complete recovery. SkyTeam – solely operated under Delta, lost 4.5 percentage points. Delta’s exposure at Narita and dependency on Honolulu left it disadvantaged post-COVID. By extension, Hawaiian Airlines also lost a significant share due to its HNL headquarter location seeing fewer Japanese travelers. The exodus from Narita paved the way for a new entrant: ZIPAIR, providing an LCC alternate to the legacy carriers, capturing 5.4% of the market.

United and American both surpassed their 2019 passenger levels. Delta at 64% of 2019 levels is the most striking underperformer; a reflection of its heavy exposure at Narita and drop in passenger levels in Detroit and Minneapolis.

Within the two legacy Japanese carriers, ANA and JAL contrast greatly. ANA entered COVID with 26 routes and emerged with 25; a leaner, more focused network that fully recovered to 2019 amounts. JAL entered with 48 routes and has since reduced to 35 in 2025. Despite an improved load factor of 85.1%, JAL’s passenger levels remain at only 83% of its 2019 benchmark, in large part due to its network reductions. Notably, ANA crossed above JAL in passengers in 2025, after previously remaining below the latter in aggregate passengers across the corridor over the period.

ZIPAIR (ZG), a low-cost subsidiary of JAL, was launched in 2020. It stands as the corridor’s sole new entrant, and the only one to operate under a low-cost carrier (LCC) model. It operates exclusively out of Narita, serving primarily West-Coast U.S. cities such as Los Angeles, San

Francisco, and San Jose. After peaking at 530,745 passengers in 2024, ZIPAIR saw negligible change in 2025, with a net loss of 301 passengers on the corridor in 2025, with load factors in the range of 76-81%. It represents an intriguing alternative and aims to fill the price-sensitive segment that is poorly captured by the legacy carriers. This dual approach by JAL – rationalizing the mainline network down while also launching an LCC subsidiary on the same corridor – represents an intriguing, if unconventional strategy by the JAL group; conceding some of its ground on volume at the premium end, while allocating more resources towards opening up a new front at the price-sensitive end.

The Honolulu and Guam Collapse

Honolulu and Guam represent the two most significant underperforming markets post-COVID, each being at a mere 62% of their 2019 counterparts. Both markets are structurally tied to Japanese-outbound leisure travel in a way that no continental U.S. gateway currently is.

The historic depreciation of the yen against the USD since 2022 has made American destinations significantly more expensive for Japanese consumers in terms of their local currency. A family planning a vacation to Hawaii for 110 yen/USD in 2019 would face costs around 35-40% higher in the present day with conversion rates pushing towards 160 yen/USD. Income growth in Japan has not matched this critical weakening of the yen, driving away leisure travel at great speeds.

The supply has certainly accounted for this event. United, which carried 171,000 HNL-Japan passengers in 2019, effectively exited the market entirely by 2025, redirecting its newly acquired Haneda slots to higher-yielding routes on the American mainland. Delta fell from 441,000 to 129,000 passengers, following suit. Airlines recognized the weakened demand and redirected valuable Haneda slots elsewhere.

Secondary Japanese city routes from Honolulu – the likes of Sendai, Kumamoto, Niigata, amongst others, who serve Japanese regional travelers, have essentially been eliminated. These routes depended entirely on Japanese outbound demand to justify their existence, and their disappearance is clearer evidence of structural constraining rather than a temporary disruption. Meanwhile, HNL-HND has grown to 1.94x of 2019 numbers, driven by ANA's expansion – demonstrating that some demand persists, just at a lower level, and concentrated towards Haneda.

Implications

For Passengers – American travelers visiting Japan enjoy a rapidly-expanded corridor. New nonstop options from Washington (IAD), Seattle, Detroit, and Atlanta provide direct access to the world's largest metro that did not meaningfully exist pre-COVID. The weakened yen has made Japan an extremely affordable destination for U.S. travelers, though rising jet fuel prices throughout 2026 have offset the honeymoon phase to an extent. Spring and autumn demand surges have become highly competitive, with earlier booking necessary in many cases, with

higher pricing reflecting the explosion of demand in those seasons. Passengers can also enjoy new direct routes to other major Japanese cities, with United having launched SFO-KIX, and will be launching a seasonal route from SFO-CTS, being the first carrier to connect the island of Hokkaido to the United States.

Japanese travelers face the opposite scenario: the same weak yen that makes Japan an attractive destination for Americans has made U.S. destinations in the Pacific significantly more expensive for them. Hawaii and Guam have experienced sharp reductions in demand and capacity as a result. Japanese travelers face far fewer nonstop options to these markets, and secondary city routes that once allowed for a return home from Honolulu directly have fallen off the map. The options that remain are highly concentrated at Haneda, with more of an emphasis on capturing premium, high-yield travelers rather than leisure.

For Airlines – U.S. carriers have been the primary beneficiaries of the reconstruction. United's six-fold growth at Haneda, American's 11% passenger increase, and successful launches of new city pairs demonstrate that U.S. carriers used the disruption caused by COVID to tactically reposition their Japan networks. Haneda's slot expansion granted access to a superior airport, and Star Alliance's execution has grown their market share on the corridor from 41.6% to 47.2%.

JAL's relative underperformance relative to ANA represents the most significant Japanese-carrier story. JAL's pre-COVID network depth, featuring 48 routes to the U.S. versus ANA's 26, proved to become a liability during recovery, necessitating a harsh contraction to rationalize their future path forward that ANA did not need to conduct themselves. The two carriers entered 2026 at 83% and 104% of their respective 2019 passenger levels, a gap that more so reflects the strategic decisions made in the years prior to COVID. ANA's crossing above JAL in total corridor passengers this past year marks a significant competitive milestone that may have been a far-fetched achievement in 2019.

Hawaiian Airlines' underperformance, also at 83% of their 2019 levels reflects the structural disadvantage it once held, before merging with Alaska Airlines in 2026. As Hawaiian did not hold any mainland routes to Haneda, they were unable to fully participate in the slot expansion that drove growth for many of its U.S. competitors. It's HNL-Japan business, highly dependent on Japanese travelers, faced the same headwinds that plagued the leisure market, and its corridor market share would fall from 14.6% to 8.8%. However, with the new merger in place, the combined network can now effectively connect passengers through Honolulu, acting as a direct remedy to the structural isolation effects which plagued Hawaiian's performance as an independent carrier.

ZIPAIR's emergence with 530,000 passengers within five years of operation demonstrates that a transpacific LCC model is commercially viable when paired with favorable market conditions and strong slot access. Consistent load factors suggest that it has found a durable segment beneath the legacy carriers – though rising fuel prices may prove to be an important stress test of the model. ZIPAIR's 2026 performance may be highly volatile as a result.

Limitations

There exist constraints of this analysis that deserve acknowledgment: T-100 data does not directly record traveler nationality; the gateway-level view used to distinguish American-origin from Japanese-origin is inferential. A market such as Honolulu carries both American and Japanese travelers, but T-100 data does not disaggregate them. The argument that HNL and GUM declines reflect Japanese demand suppression is backed up by carrier evidence and overall market structure but cannot be fully confirmed without booking-level origin data.

The yen depreciation argument, while compelling, cannot be directly tested in this dataset. Separating currency from other relevant factors; Japan's changing demographics, travel preferences post-COVID, and nuanced competitive dynamics would require passenger survey data or fare data by origin country, neither of which is currently available to the public at this time. While T-100 data lacks currency tracking, the drop in Honolulu's seat density mirrors the drop in Japanese visitor arrivals reported by Hawaii's DBEDT – which indicated Japanese arrivals hovered at just 46.5% of 2019 levels.

The fleet evolution analysis showed the B787/A350 share of corridor departures fell from 7.7% to 5.3% between 2019-2025, while the “other widebodies” grew substantially. This is more likely to reflect supply chain complications post-COVID, where airlines were forced to delay retirements and further utilize older, existing widebodies to capture exploding American demand.

T-100 captures operated flights exclusively. Other confounding elements such as charter flights, code-share agreements, and connecting itineraries routed through non-U.S. hubs are not recorded in the dataset and cannot be accounted for.

Conclusion

The U.S.-Japan travel corridor in 2025 carried 91% of its 2019 passenger volume, yet that single number tells only a fraction of the full story. Beneath the recovery aggregation are two demand populations moving in conflicting directions, an airport transition that reshuffled competitive dynamics for all parties involved, a new LCC competitor, a sizable market share shift, and a shift in the seasonal profile that reflects which demand population dominates the corridor.

The Haneda slot expansion acts as the defining event of the post-COVID corridor, creating fresh city pairs while enabling rapid U.S. carrier growth across the corridor.

The yen's role – simultaneously attracting American tourists to Japan and repelling Japanese outbound travel produced geographic-level asymmetry present in load factor rates. Mainland U.S. gateways fully recovered, and managed to exceed 2019 levels, whereas island destinations are still a shadow of their former selves in the data without a road towards full recovery.

The corridor reorganized around different airports, different traveler populations, and a new seasonal rhythm, but the 91% aggregate recovery is the least interesting amongst those findings.

Appendix A: U.S.-Japan Corridor Passenger Volume by Carrier (2019-2025)

Carrier	Code	2019 Pax	2023 Pax	2024 Pax	2025 Pax	Index
U.S. Carriers						
United Airlines	UA	2,380,826	1,969,743	2,298,599	2,459,102	1.03x
American Airlines	AA	730,953	532,527	696,873	809,792	1.11x
Delta Air Lines	DL	1,616,430	789,145	942,005	1,035,931	0.64x
Hawaiian Airlines	HA	844,937	555,863	660,348	702,373	0.83x
Japanese Carriers						
ANA	NH	2,113,474	1,862,670	2,078,745	2,204,024	1.04x
Japan Airlines	JL	2,388,715	1,884,240	2,136,188	1,976,818	0.83x
New Entrant / LCC						
ZIPAIR	ZG	—	429,090	530,745	530,444	New

Table A1 - Annual passenger volumes for major U.S.-Japan corridor carriers, grouped by home country. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix B: Haneda (HND) U.S. Gateway Breakdown (2019-2025)

Code	Gateway	2019	2022	2023	2024	2025	Index	2025 LF
LAX	Los Angeles, CA	524,171	267,658	975,654	1,060,621	1,094,583	2.09x	87.9%
JFK	New York, NY	259,792	186,333	409,060	636,637	668,906	2.57x	83.8%
ORD	Chicago, IL	135,911	169,253	416,469	447,242	445,260	3.28x	83.5%
SFO	San Francisco, CA	288,079	176,940	427,034	417,285	419,548	1.46x	84.2%
SEA	Seattle, WA	481	89,042	254,126	278,522	323,464	672x	84.3%
DFW	Dallas/Fort Worth, TX	230	66,011	254,541	300,551	286,217	1,244x	88.8%

IAD	Washington, DC	4	8,934	213,719	261,924	270,984	67,746x	80.5%
DTW	Detroit, MI	513	54,036	147,505	165,321	182,127	355x	83.7%
ATL	Atlanta, GA	533	80,951	173,739	180,439	178,913	336x	86.4%
MSP	Minneapolis, MN	162,737	0	99,226	132,509	164,926	1.01x	78.7%
EWR	Newark, NJ	—	4	130,596	149,675	157,378	New	80.8%
IAH	Houston, TX	—	9,608	112,412	128,999	133,261	New	86.0%

Table A2 - U.S. gateway cities with HND service. Gateways showing "—" in 2019 had no pre-COVID Haneda service. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix C: U.S. vs Japanese/Foreign Carrier Split (2019-2025)

Year	U.S. Carrier Passengers	U.S. LF	U.S. Index	JP/Foreign Passengers	JP/Foreign LF	JP/Foreign Index
2019	5,577,329	83.4%	1.00x	5,231,651	80.5%	1.00x
2020	1,162,234	53.1%	0.21x	1,180,644	48.8%	0.23x
2021	315,819	23.1%	0.06x	490,474	25.6%	0.09x
2022	1,303,564	58.6%	0.23x	2,275,234	64.0%	0.43x
2023	3,847,947	76.8%	0.69x	4,394,522	77.5%	0.84x
2024	4,598,323	75.5%	0.82x	4,915,808	78.6%	0.94x
2025	5,007,398	83.2%	0.90x	4,874,209	82.9%	0.93x

Table A3 - Annual passengers and load factor by carrier nationality. U.S. carriers surpassed Japanese/Foreign carriers in 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix D: HNL-Japan Breakdown by Carrier (2019-2025)

Carrier	Code	2019 Pax	2023 Pax	2024 Pax	2025 Pax	Index	2019 LF	2025 LF
Japan Airlines	JL	810,797	498,679	571,133	554,359	0.68x	81.1%	86.2%
Hawaiian Airlines	HA	780,346	552,763	653,709	602,217	0.77x	90.5%	81.7%
ANA	NH	535,762	440,009	592,256	664,992	1.24x	85.7%	80.0%
Delta Air Lines	DL	441,175	21,527	113,385	128,766	0.29x	88.2%	83.5%
United Airlines	UA	171,072	247	0	984	0.01x	86.2%	84.9%

Table A4 - Honolulu-Japan carriers with $\geq 10,000$ passengers in 2019. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix E: Monthly Passenger Volume, U.S.-Japan Corridor (2019-2025)

Year	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2019	859,253	788,457	964,517	813,143	896,414	925,322	942,349	1,020,447	929,164	881,366	880,444	908,104
2020	919,544	779,827	349,153	17,936	15,165	25,412	34,863	38,045	37,196	38,757	35,839	51,141
2021	45,624	27,303	39,267	39,986	53,116	71,998	85,103	92,968	62,754	64,438	106,140	117,596
2022	98,539	71,759	134,241	185,064	247,628	324,157	382,646	427,734	358,298	372,017	445,598	531,117
2023	523,803	443,143	660,075	619,108	690,962	767,741	798,214	815,952	728,614	738,277	727,392	729,188
2024	692,278	648,466	837,664	724,647	806,731	854,671	859,490	865,456	772,508	841,986	795,373	814,861
2025	799,463	708,046	914,409	841,104	872,423	883,158	683,278	914,923	831,249	711,107	848,977	873,470

Table A5 - Monthly corridor passenger totals. July 2025 trough reflects carrier capacity scheduling rather than demand weakness. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix F: JAL vs. ANA Head-to-Head Comparison (2019-2025)

Year	JAL Passengers	JAL LF	JAL Routes	JAL Index	ANA Passengers	ANA LF	ANA Routes	ANA Index
2019	2,388,715	80.8%	48	1.00x	2,113,474	79.6%	26	1.00x
2020	529,850	49.9%	51	0.22x	525,525	44.9%	36	0.25x
2021	233,861	26.0%	41	0.10x	239,894	25.6%	39	0.11x

2022	1,117,755	65.8%	40	0.47x	933,094	67.1%	38	0.44x
2023	1,884,240	78.0%	40	0.79x	1,862,670	78.4%	31	0.88x
2024	2,136,188	80.9%	36	0.89x	2,078,745	75.6%	24	0.98x
2025	1,976,818	85.1%	35	0.83x	2,204,024	82.4%	25	1.04x

Table A6 - Annual passengers, load factor, and route count for Japan Airlines and ANA. ANA exceeded JAL in corridor passengers for the first time in 2025. Source: BTS T-100.

Appendix G: Top U.S.-Japan Routes by 2025 Passenger Volume

Route	U.S. Gateway	Japan Gateway	2019 Pax	2025 Pax	Change	Index	2019 LF	2025 LF
LAX–HND	Los Angeles, CA	Tokyo (HND)	524,171	1,094,583	+570,412	2.09x	85.8%	87.9%
HNL–HND	Honolulu, HI	Tokyo (HND)	451,141	875,080	+423,939	1.94x	90.8%	86.3%
LAX–NRT	Los Angeles, CA	Tokyo (NRT)	889,475	725,612	-163,863	0.82x	80.6%	85.7%
HNL–NRT	Honolulu, HI	Tokyo (NRT)	1,643,631	708,773	-934,858	0.43x	84.9%	78.1%
JFK–HND	New York, NY	Tokyo (HND)	259,792	668,906	+409,114	2.57x	78.1%	83.8%
SFO–NRT	San Francisco, CA	Tokyo (NRT)	349,932	586,272	+236,340	1.68x	78.7%	82.2%
ORD–HND	Chicago, IL	Tokyo (HND)	135,911	445,260	+309,349	3.28x	74.8%	83.5%
SFO–HND	San Francisco, CA	Tokyo (HND)	288,079	419,548	+131,469	1.46x	80.3%	84.2%
GUM–NRT	Guam, TT	Tokyo (NRT)	695,176	383,782	-311,394	0.55x	84.2%	78.9%

SEA– HND	Seattle, WA	Tokyo (HND)	481	323,464	+322,983	672x	93.6%	84.3%
DFW– HND	Dallas/Fort Worth, TX	Tokyo (HND)	230	286,217	+285,987	1,244x	75.7%	88.8%
HNL– KIX	Honolulu, HI	Osaka (KIX)	748,171	273,713	-474,458	0.37x	85.3%	84.6%
IAD– HND	Washington, DC	Tokyo (HND)	4	270,984	+270,980	67,746x	28.6%	80.5%
IAH– NRT	Houston, TX	Tokyo (NRT)	316,462	225,574	-90,888	0.71x	82.0%	78.5%
SEA– NRT	Seattle, WA	Tokyo (NRT)	369,670	204,746	-164,924	0.55x	83.6%	83.0%
DTW– HND	Detroit, MI	Tokyo (HND)	513	182,127	+181,614	355x	84.4%	83.7%
ATL– HND	Atlanta, GA	Tokyo (HND)	533	178,913	+178,380	336x	92.5%	86.4%
DEN– NRT	Denver, CO	Tokyo (NRT)	136,698	168,703	+32,005	1.23x	86.2%	90.4%
MSP– HND	Minneapolis, MN	Tokyo (HND)	162,737	164,926	+2,189	1.01x	77.4%	78.7%

Table A7 – Top U.S.-Japan routes in 2025, sorted by 2025 volume. Source: BTS T-100.